

Januscape - Linux KVM VM Escape (July 6, 2026)

Key Points:

- CVE-2026-53359
- Found via Google's kvmCTF bug bounty program
- A Use After Free vulnerability was discovered within KVM was discovered and publicly disclosed on July 6, 2026 and had been running for 16 years
- The flaw existed inside the shadow memory management unit (MMU) code and allowed a guest vm with root access and nested virtualization enabled to corrupt the host's shadow page bookkeeping
 - August 2010(Code with bug committed) - July 4, 2026 (Patched stable kernel packages were released by Linux)
- Every KVM host running nested virtualization carries the defect
- Though actual exploitation still requires an attacker with root access inside a guest VM

Mitigations:

- KVM-based virtualization infrastructure should confirm that host kernels have been updated to a fixed version: 7.1.3, 6.18.38, 6.12.95, 6.6.144, 6.1.177, 5.15.211, 5.10.260
- Where an immediate kernel update is not possible, disable nested virtualization on hosts that do not require it

Source:

<https://labs.cloudsecurityalliance.org/research/csa-research-note-januscape-kvm-guest-host-escape-cve-2026-5/>